

MAVEN ENGLISH REFERENCE GUIDE

VERBS

Verbs, phrasal verbs and idioms



BILINGUAL EDITION

Essential forms / everyday usage / bilingual examples



DAILY ROUTINE VERBS

Base form · Past · Past participle · Spanish meaning

#	VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING	-ED
1	WAKE UP	WOKE UP	WOKEN UP	DESPERTAR	
2	TAKE A SHOWER	TOOK A SHOWER	TAKEN A SHOWER	TOMAR UNA DUCHA	
3	BRUSH	BRUSHED	BRUSHED	CEPILLAR	/t/
4	GET DRESSED	GOT DRESSED	GOTTEN DRESSED	VESTIRSE	
5	HAVE BREAKFAST	HAD BREAKFAST	HAD BREAKFAST	DESAYUNAR	
6	HAVE LUNCH	HAD LUNCH	HAD LUNCH	ALMORZAR	
7	HAVE DINNER	HAD DINNER	HAD DINNER	CENAR	
8	GO	WENT	GONE	IR	
9	CHECK	CHECKED	CHECKED	REVISAR	/t/
10	WORK	WORKED	WORKED	TRABAJAR	/t/
11	STUDY	STUDIED	STUDIED	ESTUDIAR	/d/
12	WATCH	WATCHED	WATCHED	MIRAR, OBSERVAR	/t/
13	DO	DID	DONE	HACER	
14	MAKE	MADE	MADE	HACER, CREAR	
15	CHAT	CHATTED	CHATTED	CHATEAR	/ɪd/
16	TEXT	TEXTED	TEXTED	MENSAJEAR	/ɪd/
17	PLAY	PLAYED	PLAYED	JUGAR	/d/
18	COOK	COOKED	COOKED	COCINAR	/t/
19	CALL	CALLED	CALLED	LLAMAR	/d/
20	COME BACK	CAME BACK	COME BACK	REGRESAR	
21	EAT	ATE	EATEN	COMER	
22	DRIVE	DROVE	DRIVEN	CONducir	
23	READ	READ	READ	LEER	
24	DRINK	DRANK	DRUNK	BEBER	
25	LISTEN	LISTENED	LISTENED	ESCUCHAR	/d/
26	CLEAN	CLEANED	CLEANED	LIMPIAR	/d/
27	SLEEP	SLEPT	SLEPT	DORMIR	

-ED pronunciation is shown only for regular verbs.

MOST COMMON VERBS

Base form · Past · Past participle · Spanish meaning

#	VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING	-ED
1	RIDE	RODE	RIDDEN	MONTAR, ANDAR EN	
2	GET	GOT	GOTTEN	OBTENER	
3	GIVE	GAVE	GIVEN	DAR	
4	SEE	SAW	SEEN	VER	
5	LOOK	LOOKED	LOOKED	MIRAR, OBSERVAR	/t/
6	TAKE	TOOK	TAKEN	TOMAR	
7	THINK	THOUGHT	THOUGHT	PENSAR	
8	WASH	WASHED	WASHED	LAVAR	/t/
9	HAVE	HAD	HAD	TENER	
10	FIND	FOUND	FOUND	ENCONTRAR	
11	LEARN	LEARNED	LEARNED	APRENDER	/d/
12	WRITE	WROTE	WRITTEN	ESCRIBIR	
13	WALK	WALKED	WALKED	CAMINAR	/t/
14	CAN	COULD	—	PODER	
15	WANT	WANTED	WANTED	QUERER, DESEAR	/ɪd/
16	NEED	NEEDED	NEEDED	NECESITAR	/ɪd/
17	LIKE	LIKED	LIKED	GUSTAR	/t/
18	TALK	TALKED	TALKED	HABLAR, CONVERSAR	/t/
19	SPEAK	SPOKE	SPOKEN	HABLAR	
20	REMEMBER	REMEMBERED	REMEMBERED	RECORDAR	/d/
21	UNDERSTAND	UNDERSTOOD	UNDERSTOOD	ENTENDER	
22	SPEND	SPENT	SPENT	GASTAR, PASAR TIEMPO	
23	TRY	TRIED	TRIED	INTENTAR	/d/
24	SWIM	SWAM	SWUM	NADAR	
25	START	STARTED	STARTED	EMPEZAR	/ɪd/
26	SAY	SAID	SAID	DECIR	
27	TELL	TOLD	TOLD	CONTAR, NARRAR	

American English forms are used throughout.

MOST COMMON VERBS

Base form · Past · Past participle · Spanish meaning

#	VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING	-ED
28	BUY	BOUGHT	BOUGHT	COMPRAR	
29	BRING	BROUGHT	BROUGHT	TRAER	
30	CHANGE	CHANGED	CHANGED	CAMBIAR	/d/
31	CUT	CUT	CUT	CORTAR	
32	FALL	FELL	FALLEN	CAER	
33	FIX	FIXED	FIXED	REPARAR	/t/
34	FORGET	FORGOT	FORGOTTEN	OLVIDAR	
35	LOSE	LOST	LOST	PERDER	
36	OPEN	OPENED	OPENED	ABRIR	/d/
37	CLOSE	CLOSED	CLOSED	CERRAR	/d/
38	PAY	PAID	PAID	PAGAR	
39	PUT	PUT	PUT	PONER	
40	RUN	RAN	RUN	CORRER	
41	SEND	SENT	SENT	ENVIAR	
42	FEEL	FELT	FELT	SENTIR	
43	TEACH	TAUGHT	TAUGHT	ENSEÑAR	
44	WAIT	WAITED	WAITED	ESPERAR	/ɪd/
45	FLY	FLEW	FLOWN	VOLAR	
46	LEAVE	LEFT	LEFT	DEJAR, SALIR	
47	KNOW	KNEW	KNOWN	SABER, CONOCER	
48	BELIEVE	BELIEVED	BELIEVED	CREER	/d/
49	BECOME	BECAME	BECOME	LLEGAR A SER	
50	ASK	ASKED	ASKED	PEDIR, PREGUNTAR	/t/
51	HEAR	HEARD	HEARD	OÍR, ESCUCHAR	
52	USE	USED	USED	USAR	/d/
53	SING	SANG	SUNG	CANTAR	
54	PICK UP	PICKED UP	PICKED UP	RECOGER	/t/

American English forms are used throughout.

IRREGULAR VERBS

Revised American English forms

VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING
ARISE	AROSE	ARISEN	ELEVARSE, SURGIR, ORIGINARSE
AWAKE	AWOKE	AWOKEN	DESPERTAR, DESPERTARSE
BEAR	BORE	BORNE / BORN	SOPORTAR; DAR A LUZ
BEAT	BEAT	BEATEN	GOLPEAR, VENCER
BECOME	BECAME	BECOME	HACERSE, CONVERTIRSE EN
BEGIN	BEGAN	BEGUN	EMPEZAR, INICIAR
BEND	BENT	BENT	DOBLAR, INCLINAR
BET	BET	BET	APOSTAR
BIND	BOUND	BOUND	ATAR, UNIR, ENLAZAR
BITE	BIT	BITTEN	MORDER
BLOW	BLEW	BLOWN	SOPLAR
BREAK	BROKE	BROKEN	ROMPER, QUEBRAR
BRING	BROUGHT	BROUGHT	TRAER, LLEVAR
BUILD	BUILT	BUILT	CONSTRUIR, EDIFICAR
BURN	BURNED / BURNT	BURNED / BURNT	QUEMAR, INCENDIAR
BURST	BURST	BURST	REVENTAR, ESTALLAR
BUY	BOUGHT	BOUGHT	COMPRAR
CATCH	CAUGHT	CAUGHT	COGER, ATRAPAR
CHOOSE	CHOSE	CHOSEN	ESCOGER, ELEGIR
CLING	CLUNG	CLUNG	AFERRARSE, ADHERIRSE

IRREGULAR VERBS

Revised American English forms

VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING
COME	CAME	COME	VENIR
COST	COST	COST	COSTAR
CREEP	CREPT	CREPT	ARRASTRARSE, AVANZAR SIGILOSAMENTE
CUT	CUT	CUT	CORTAR, DIVIDIR
DEAL	DEALT	DEALT	TRATAR, NEGOCIAR
DIG	DUG	DUG	CAVAR, AHONDAR
DO	DID	DONE	HACER, EJECUTAR
DRAW	DREW	DRAWN	DIBUJAR, ATRAER
DRINK	DRANK	DRUNK	BEBER
DRIVE	DROVE	DRIVEN	CONducir, LLEVAR
FALL	FELL	FALLEN	CAER, DISMINUIR
FEED	FED	FED	ALIMENTAR, NUTRIR
FEEL	FELT	FELT	SENTIR
FIGHT	FOUGHT	FOUGHT	PELEAR, COMBATIR
FIND OUT	FOUND OUT	FOUND OUT	DESCUBRIR, AVERIGUAR
FLEE	FLED	FLED	HUIR, ESCAPAR
FLY	FLEW	FLOWN	VOLAR
FORBID	FORBADE	FORBIDDEN	PROHIBIR
FORESEE	FORESAW	FORESEEN	PREVER, ANTICIPAR
FORGET	FORGOT	FORGOTTEN	OLVIDAR

IRREGULAR VERBS

Revised American English forms

VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING
FREEZE	FROZE	FROZEN	CONGELAR
GET	GOT	GOTTEN	OBTENER, CONSEGUIR
GIVE	GAVE	GIVEN	DAR, CONCEDER
GO	WENT	GONE	IR, FUNCIONAR
GRIND	GROUND	GROUND	MOLER, TRITURAR
GROW	GREW	GROWN	CRECER, CULTIVAR
HANG	HUNG	HUNG	COLGAR, SUSPENDER
HAVE	HAD	HAD	TENER, HABER
HEAR	HEARD	HEARD	OÍR, ESCUCHAR
HIDE	HID	HIDDEN	OCULTAR, ESCONDER
HIT	HIT	HIT	PEGAR, GOLPEAR, ACERTAR
HOLD	HELD	HELD	SOSTENER, MANTENER
HURT	HURT	HURT	HERIR, DOLER
KEEP	KEPT	KEPT	MANTENER, GUARDAR
KNOW	KNEW	KNOWN	CONOCER, SABER
LAY	LAID	LAID	PONER, COLOCAR
LEAD	LED	LED	GUIAR, LIDERAR
LEAN	LEANED / LEANT	LEANED / LEANT	INCLINAR, APOYARSE
LEAVE	LEFT	LEFT	DEJAR, IRSE
LEND	LENT	LENT	PRESTAR

IRREGULAR VERBS

Revised American English forms

VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING
LET	LET	LET	PERMITIR, DEJAR
LIE	LIED	LIED	MENTIR
LIGHT	LIT	LIT	ENCENDER, ILUMINAR
LOSE	LOST	LOST	PERDER, MALGASTAR
MAKE	MADE	MADE	HACER, PRODUCIR
MEAN	MEANT	MEANT	SIGNIFICAR, QUERER DECIR
MEET	MET	MET	ENCONTRARSE, CONOCER
MELT	MELTED	MELTED / MOLTEN	DERRETIR, FUNDIR
MISTAKE	MISTOOK	MISTAKEN	EQUIVOCAR, CONFUNDIR
MISUNDERSTAND	MISUNDERSTOOD	MISUNDERSTOOD	ENTENDER MAL
OVERCOME	OVERCAME	OVERCOME	VENCER, SUPERAR
PAY	PAID	PAID	PAGAR, RECOMPENSAR
PUT	PUT	PUT	PONER, COLOCAR
READ	READ	READ	LEER
REBUILD	REBUILT	REBUILT	RECONSTRUIR
RID	RID	RID	LIBRAR, DESHACERSE
RIDE	RODE	RIDDEN	MONTAR, ANDAR EN
RING	RANG	RUNG	SONAR, LLAMAR
RISE	ROSE	RISEN	ASCENDER, LEVANTARSE
RUN	RAN	RUN	CORRER, FUNCIONAR

IRREGULAR VERBS

Revised American English forms

VERB	PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE	MEANING
SAW	SAWED	SAWN	ASERRAR
SAY	SAID	SAID	DECIR, AFIRMAR
SEE	SAW	SEEN	VER, OBSERVAR
SEEK	SOUGHT	SOUGHT	BUSCAR, SOLICITAR
SELL	SOLD	SOLD	VENDER
SEND	SENT	SENT	ENVIAR
SET	SET	SET	COLOCAR, FIJAR
SHAKE	SHOOK	SHAKEN	SACUDIR, AGITAR
SHED	SHED	SHED	DERRAMAR, DESPRENDER
SHINE	SHONE	SHONE	BRILLAR, SOBRESALIR
SHOOT	SHOT	SHOT	DISPARAR, LANZAR
SHOW	SHOWED	SHOWN	MOSTRAR, DEMOSTRAR
SHRINK	SHRANK	SHRUNK	ENCOGERSE, DISMINUIR
SHUT	SHUT	SHUT	CERRAR, IMPEDIR
SING	SANG	SUNG	CANTAR
SINK	SANK	SUNK	HUNDIR, SUMERGIR
SIT	SAT	SAT	SENTARSE
SLEEP	SLEPT	SLEPT	DORMIR
SLIDE	SLID	SLID	DESLIZAR, RESBALAR

Turn the reference into active speaking practice.

1. Choose ten verbs and say one present-tense sentence for each.

2. Retell yesterday using at least eight past-tense verbs.

3. Make five present-perfect sentences with past participles.

4. Contrast two verbs that have similar Spanish meanings.

5. Record yourself and check pronunciation, rhythm, and clarity.

6. Review the irregular verbs you still hesitate to use.

SPEAK IT. USE IT. REMEMBER IT.

Practice out loud and create one personal example for every item.



MAVEN ENGLISH REFERENCE GUIDE

PHRASAL VERBS

A complete bilingual reference for your English journey

PHRASAL VERB	ENGLISH MEANING	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
BREAK IN ON	interrupt a conversation	<i>interrumpir una conversación</i>	The supervisor broke in on our discussion to share an update.
CATCH UP WITH	reach the same level or get current	<i>ponerse al día con</i>	I need to catch up with the lessons I missed.
CHECK UP ON	examine or investigate	<i>revisar, verificar</i>	The technician checked up on the system after the alert.
COME UP WITH	produce an idea or solution	<i>proponer, idear</i>	She came up with a simple way to explain the rule.
CUT DOWN ON	reduce the amount of something	<i>reducir</i>	We are trying to cut down on unnecessary expenses.
DROP OUT OF	leave a course or school before finishing	<i>abandonar los estudios</i>	He did not want to drop out of the English program.
GET ALONG WITH	have a good relationship with	<i>llevarse bien con</i>	I get along with everyone in my study group.
GET AWAY WITH	avoid punishment for something wrong	<i>salirse con la suya</i>	You cannot copy homework and expect to get away with it.

PHRASAL VERB	ENGLISH MEANING	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
GET RID OF	remove or eliminate	<i>deshacerse de</i>	I got rid of old files before installing the update.
GET THROUGH WITH	finish something	<i>terminar</i>	Once I get through with this report, I can relax.
KEEP UP WITH	maintain the same pace as	<i>mantener el ritmo de</i>	It is hard to keep up with a fast speaker at first.
LOOK FORWARD TO	anticipate with pleasure	<i>esperar con ilusión</i>	We look forward to seeing you in the next class.
LOOK DOWN ON	consider someone inferior	<i>menospreciar</i>	Good leaders never look down on their team.
LOOK IN ON	visit briefly to check on someone	<i>pasar a ver</i>	I will look in on my grandmother after work.
LOOK OUT FOR	watch carefully for	<i>estar atento a</i>	Look out for pronunciation patterns in the dialogue.
LOOK UP TO	respect or admire	<i>admirar, respetar</i>	Many students look up to teachers who inspire them.
MAKE SURE OF	verify or confirm	<i>asegurarse de</i>	Make sure of the meeting time before you leave.

PHRASAL VERB	ENGLISH MEANING	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
PUT UP WITH	tolerate	<i>soportar, tolerar</i>	I cannot put up with that noise while I study.
RUN OUT OF	use all of a supply	<i>quedarse sin</i>	We ran out of printer paper during the workshop.
TAKE CARE OF	be responsible for	<i>cuidar, encargarse de</i>	She takes care of the attendance list every Friday.
TALK BACK TO	answer someone impolitely	<i>contestar de forma irrespetuosa</i>	The child apologized for talking back to his teacher.
THINK BACK ON	remember a past time	<i>recordar</i>	I often think back on my first English class.
WALK OUT ON	abandon a person or responsibility	<i>abandonar</i>	He walked out on the project without explaining why.
PASS OUT	lose consciousness	<i>desmayarse</i>	The athlete passed out from the heat and received help.
SHOW OFF	display proudly to impress others	<i>presumir</i>	He likes to show off his new vocabulary.
SHOW UP	arrive or appear	<i>aparecer, llegar</i>	Please show up ten minutes before the lesson.
WAKE UP	stop sleeping	<i>despertarse</i>	I wake up early to review vocabulary.

PHRASAL VERB	ENGLISH MEANING	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
BREAK DOWN	stop functioning	<i>averiarse, dejar de funcionar</i>	My laptop broke down before the presentation.
CATCH ON	become popular or understand	<i>ponerse de moda; entender</i>	The new study method quickly caught on.
COME BACK	return to a place	<i>regresar</i>	Come back tomorrow and we will finish the activity.
COME IN	enter	<i>entrar</i>	Please come in and take a seat.
COME TO	regain consciousness	<i>recobrar el conocimiento</i>	He came to a few minutes after fainting.
COME OVER	visit someone	<i>venir de visita</i>	My classmates are coming over to practice speaking.
DROP BY	visit without a formal appointment	<i>pasar de visita</i>	Drop by the academy whenever you need help.
EAT OUT	eat at a restaurant	<i>comer fuera</i>	We usually eat out after the final class.

PHRASAL VERB	ENGLISH MEANING	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
GET BY	manage to survive or cope	<i>arreglárselas</i>	She can get by in English while traveling.
GET UP	rise from bed or a chair	<i>levantarse</i>	I get up at six on weekdays.
GO BACK	return to a place	<i>volver</i>	I would love to go back to London one day.
GO ON	continue	<i>continuar</i>	Please go on with your explanation.
GO ON (2)	happen	<i>suceder</i>	What is going on in the next classroom?
GROW UP	become older or mature	<i>crecer</i>	She grew up speaking two languages.
KEEP AWAY	remain at a distance	<i>mantenerse alejado</i>	Keep away from the wet floor.
KEEP ON + GERUND	continue doing the same activity	<i>seguir haciendo</i>	Keep on practicing and your fluency will improve.

Use phrasal verbs in realistic situations.

1. Explain your morning routine using wake up, get up, and go on.

2. Describe a problem using break down, run out of, and figure out.

3. Create a short dialogue with show up, come over, and drop by.

4. Tell a story using at least five phrasal verbs from this guide.

5. Replace a one-word verb with a natural phrasal verb when possible.

6. Practice the stress pattern: emphasize the main verb and particle.

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MAVEN ENGLISH REFERENCE GUIDE

IDIOMS

A complete bilingual reference for your English journey

ABOUT TO (DO SOMETHING) - A PUNTO DE

be on the point of doing something

Example: I was about to call you when your message arrived.

AS FOR MYSELF - EN CUANTO A MÍ

with regard to oneself

Example: As for myself, I prefer studying in the morning.

ACCORDING TO (SOMEONE OR SOMETHING) - DE ACUERDO CON

as stated by a person or source

Example: According to the schedule, class begins at seven.

AS IF - COMO SI

in a way that suggests something is true

Example: He speaks as if he knew everyone here.

ACCOUNT FOR (SOMETHING) - EXPLICAR

explain the reason for something

Example: The heavy traffic accounts for the delay.

AS LONG AS - SIEMPRE QUE

provided that

Example: You can borrow the book as long as you return it Friday.

AFTER ALL - DESPUÉS DE TODO

used to add a reason or reminder

Example: You should ask her; after all, she manages the project.

AS SOON AS - TAN PRONTO COMO

immediately after something happens

Example: Call me as soon as you arrive.

ALL OF A SUDDEN - DE REPENTE

suddenly and unexpectedly

Example: All of a sudden, the lights went out.

AS TO - EN CUANTO A

with regard to

Example: As to your question, we will discuss it after class.

AS A MATTER OF FACT - DE HECHO

used to emphasize what is actually true

Example: As a matter of fact, I have already finished the course.

AS WELL - TAMBIÉN

in addition

Example: She studies grammar and practices pronunciation as well.

AS FAR AS I KNOW - POR LO QUE SÉ

based on the information one has

Example: As far as I know, the meeting is still online.

AS WELL AS - ASÍ COMO

in addition to

Example: Bring your notebook as well as a pen.

BACK AND FORTH - DE UN LADO A OTRO

repeatedly in opposite directions

Example: We emailed back and forth until we solved the issue.

BETTER OFF - EN UNA MEJOR SITUACIÓN

in a more favorable situation

Example: You would be better off saving a little each month.

BREAK DOWN (SOMETHING) - DESGLOSAR

divide something into smaller parts

Example: Let us break down the sentence step by step.

BREAK UP - ROMPER, SEPARARSE

separate or end a relationship or group

Example: The band broke up after its final tour.

BY THE WAY - POR CIERTO

used to introduce an additional comment

Example: By the way, did you complete the homework?

CARRY OUT (SOMETHING) - LLEVAR A CABO

put a plan or task into action

Example: The team carried out the survey last week.

COME ON! - ¡VAMOS!

used to encourage or show impatience

Example: Come on! We are going to be late.

COME UP - SURGIR

happen or appear unexpectedly

Example: A new opportunity came up this morning.

COME UP WITH (SOMETHING) - PROPONER, IDEAR

produce an idea or answer

Example: Can you come up with another example?

DEAL WITH (SOMETHING) - TRATAR CON

take action about a situation

Example: We will deal with the complaint today.

END UP (DOING / GOING) - TERMINAR

finally do or become something unexpectedly

Example: We ended up studying at the library.

FIGURE OUT - ENTENDER, RESOLVER

understand or solve something

Example: I finally figured out how the program works.

FILL IN (SOMETHING) - RELLENAR

write information in blank spaces

Example: Please fill in the registration form.

FIND OUT (SOMETHING) - DESCUBRIR, AVERIGUAR

learn or discover information

Example: I found out that the class had changed rooms.

FIRST OF ALL - PRIMERO QUE TODO

before anything else

Example: First of all, let us review yesterday's lesson.

FOR GOOD - PARA SIEMPRE

permanently

Example: She moved abroad for good.

FOR SURE - CON SEGURIDAD

certainly, without doubt

Example: I will be there for sure.

GET BACK TO (SOMETHING) - RETOMAR

return to an activity or topic

Example: Let us get back to the main question.

GET INTO (SOMETHING) - INVOLUCRARSE

become interested or involved

Example: He got into photography during college.

GET INTO (SOMEWHERE) - ENTRAR

gain admission or enter

Example: She hopes to get into a good university.

GET OUT OF (SOMEWHERE) - SALIR DE

leave or escape from a place

Example: We got out of the building safely.

GET RID OF (SOMETHING) - DESHACERSE DE

remove, sell, or throw away

Example: I need to get rid of these old notes.

GET THROUGH (SOMETHING) - TERMINAR, SUPERAR

complete or survive something difficult

Example: We got through the exam without problems.

GO AHEAD - SEGUIR ADELANTE

begin or continue with permission

Example: Go ahead and ask your question.

HANG OUT - PASAR EL RATO

spend relaxed time with people

Example: We hang out after class on Fridays.

HAVE SOMETHING TO DO WITH - TENER RELACIÓN CON

be related to a topic or situation

Example: The article has something to do with language learning.

HOLD ON - ESPERAR

wait briefly or stay on the phone

Example: Hold on while I check your information.

IN A WAY - EN CIERTA FORMA

to some extent

Example: In a way, this exercise is easier than the last one.

IN COMMON - EN COMÚN

shared by two or more people

Example: We discovered that we have many interests in common.

IN DETAIL - EN DETALLE

with complete information

Example: The teacher explained the rule in detail.

IN EFFECT - EN EFECTO

in practical terms

Example: The new policy is, in effect, a complete change.

IN FACT - DE HECHO

used to add a true or stronger point

Example: He speaks French; in fact, he teaches it.

IN FAVOR OF - A FAVOR DE

supporting a person or idea

Example: Most students were in favor of the new schedule.

IN GENERAL - EN GENERAL

in most cases

Example: In general, regular practice produces better results.

IN ORDER TO - PARA

for the purpose of

Example: She practices daily in order to improve her fluency.

IN OTHER WORDS - EN OTRAS PALABRAS

said in a clearer or different way

Example: In other words, you need to try again.

IN PLACE - EN SU LUGAR, EN ORDEN

in the correct position or arrangement

Example: Everything was in place before the event began.

KEEP (SOMEONE OR SOMETHING) IN MIND - TENER EN MENTE

remember when making a decision

Example: Keep the deadline in mind when planning your work.

MAKE SURE - ASEGURARSE

confirm that something is true or done

Example: Make sure the microphone is working.

KIND OF - MÁS O MENOS

somewhat or approximately

Example: I was kind of nervous before the interview.

MORE OR LESS - MÁS O MENOS

approximately or to some extent

Example: I have more or less finished the assignment.

LOOK FOR (SOMETHING) - BUSCAR

try to find something

Example: I am looking for my student ID.

NO MATTER - SIN IMPORTAR

regardless of the situation

Example: No matter what happens, keep practicing.

LOOK UP (SOMETHING) - CONSULTAR, BUSCAR

search for information in a reference

Example: Look up the word in a dictionary.

NOT AT ALL - PARA NADA

absolutely not

Example: I am not at all worried about the test.

MAKE A DIFFERENCE - MARCAR LA DIFERENCIA

cause an important change

Example: Ten minutes of practice can make a difference.

OF COURSE / NO DOUBT - POR SUPUESTO / SIN DUDA

certainly or naturally

Example: Of course you may ask another question.

MAKE SENSE - TENER SENTIDO

seem logical or reasonable

Example: Your explanation makes sense.

ON THE OTHER HAND - POR OTRO LADO

used to present a contrast

Example: Online classes are flexible; on the other hand, they require discipline.

PICK UP (SOMETHING) - RECOGER; ADQUIRIR

collect, receive, or learn informally

Example: I picked up several useful expressions while traveling.

SET UP (SOMETHING) - PREPARAR, ESTABLECER

arrange or create something

Example: They set up the classroom before the workshop.

POINT OUT - SEÑALAR

call attention to something

Example: The instructor pointed out a common mistake.

SHOW UP - APARECER, LLEGAR

arrive or become present

Example: Only twelve students showed up.

PUT OUT (SOMETHING) - PUBLICAR, PRODUCIR

produce or release something

Example: The academy puts out a newsletter every month.

SO FAR - HASTA AHORA

until the present moment

Example: So far, the results have been excellent.

REGARDLESS OF - INDEPENDIENTEMENTE DE

without being affected by something

Example: The event will continue regardless of the weather.

SO TO SPEAK - POR ASÍ DECIRLO

used to show that wording is figurative

Example: The final test was, so to speak, the last obstacle.

RIGHT AWAY - INMEDIATAMENTE

without delay

Example: Please send the document right away.

SORT OF - ALGO ASÍ, MÁS O MENOS

somewhat but not exactly

Example: I sort of understand the idea.

RUN INTO (TROUBLE / A PROBLEM) - ENCONTRARSE CON

encounter a difficulty unexpectedly

Example: We ran into a problem during the installation.

STICK WITH (SOMETHING) - SEGUIR CON

continue and not give up

Example: Stick with the plan for one more month.

TAKE ADVANTAGE OF - APROVECHAR

use an opportunity or resource well

Example: Take advantage of every chance to speak English.

TAKE CARE OF - CUIDAR, ENCARGARSE DE

look after or be responsible for

Example: She takes care of student registrations.

TAKE OUT (SOMETHING) - SACAR

remove something from a place

Example: Take out your notebooks, please.

TAKE OVER (SOMETHING) - TOMAR EL CONTROL

gain control or responsibility

Example: A new manager took over the department.

TAKE PLACE - TENER LUGAR

happen or occur

Example: The ceremony will take place on Saturday.

TO THE EXTENT THAT - EN LA MEDIDA EN QUE

to the degree that

Example: I can help to the extent that I know the system.

UP TO - HASTA

as far as a limit or maximum

Example: Up to twenty students may join the group.

UP TO (SOMEONE) TO DECIDE / DO - DEPENDE DE ALGUIEN

be someone's responsibility to decide

Example: It is up to you to choose the topic.

USED TO (SOMETHING) - ACOSTUMBRADO A

accustomed to a situation or activity

Example: I am used to studying at night.

WITH RESPECT TO (SOMETHING) - CON RESPECTO A

concerning a topic

Example: With respect to your request, we will answer tomorrow.

WORK OUT - FUNCIONAR, RESULTAR

end successfully or produce a solution

Example: Everything worked out well in the end.



KEEP LEARNING. KEEP SPEAKING.

A bilingual reference created for Maven English students.

THIS MATERIAL INCLUDES

27 daily-routine verbs · 54 common verbs · 99 irregular verbs
43 phrasal verbs · 86 idioms and expressions

Use the guide as a reference, then turn each item into your own sentence.